Since 1948, the Arab and Jewish populations in Israel have both grown tenfold. The government has established more than 600 new Jewish cities and towns, but not a single Arab community. A 2006 Knesset report found that Arab towns were almost twice as crowded as Jewish ones, with 1.4 people per room versus 0.86 people. Jisr az-Zarqa, an impoverished town next to the wealthy resort of Caesarea, is more densely populated than Tel Aviv. In theory, of course, Palestinian citizens of Israel are free to move anywhere in the country. But hundreds of small communities have "admissions committees", which screen out Arabs and other undesirables (like Mizrahi Jews and homosexuals). The Supreme Court upheld the legality of these committees in 2014.

The report even touched on the issue of "collective rights" for minority groups within a Jewish state (which will be explored in greater depth later). "The authorities must find ways to enable Arab citizens to express their culture and identity in a dignified fashion within the public sphere," it noted.

"Injustice applied by the state to its Arab citizens, and the discrimination against them in all areas of life, produced pent-up rage and frustration that created a convenient climate and atmosphere for the outbreak of those violent events," Hashim Khatib, a member of the commission and a district court judge from Nazareth, summarized later. "The violent explosion of the frustration and rage lacked only the spark to ignite the flame."[5]

Very little of this pent-up rage has been addressed. Both the police and the attorney general decided not to pursue any charges against the officers involved in the October events. Or would later criticize the government for failing to implement his recommendations: "The writing is still on the wall," he said.

The police continue to use heavy-handed tactics against Arab protesters. During an anti-war rally in Nazareth over the summer, they doused entire streets with foul-smelling "skunk water," laced with a noxious chemical that lingers for days on clothing and skin. The water is also frequently used against Palestinians in the West Bank and East Jerusalem, even during relatively peaceful protests; I've only seen it deployed once against a Jewish demonstration. But they neglect to do basic law-and-order policing in Arab towns, where the crime rate is consequently much higher. "Before this, I can't remember the last time I saw the police in our town," Mahrous said.